

ChatGPT Version 5.5

May 6, 2026

I am looking at a document about a late fourteenth-century pirate named Bartolomeo Pich. This document, from May 8, 1387, indicates that Bartolomeo Pich was active around Perpignan at that time. Can you find any mention of this pirate in academic secondary literature? Please provide links to any articles or monographs that you find.

I'll treat "Bartolomeo Pich" as a potentially unstable/variant name and search across likely Latin/Catalan/Italian forms, plus Perpignan/Roussillon piracy contexts around 1387.

Thought for 1m 56s

I did **not** find a secure mention of a pirate named **Bartolomeo/Bartomeu/Bartholomeus Pich** in the academic secondary literature available online. I searched likely variants including **Bartolomeo Pich, Bartomeu Pich, Bartolomeu Pich, Bartholomeus Pich, Bartholomei Pich, Barthélemy/Barthélémy Pich, Pic, Pech**, paired with **pirata, corsari/corsario, piratería, corsarisme, Perpinyà/Perpignan, Rosselló/Roussillon**, and **1387**.

The closest result for the exact or near-exact name "**Bartholomeus/Bartomeu Pich**" was **not** a pirate: it appears as a personal name in unrelated earlier documentary contexts, for example a **Bartholomeus Pich** in 1324 and a **Bartomeu Pich** connected with Xàtiva/Valencian Cortes material in 1314. Those are very likely different individuals and do not connect to Perpignan or piracy.

The most relevant academic works I checked or identified for context were:

Source	What it covers	Result for Pich
Maria Teresa Ferrer Mallol, " Corso y piratería entre Mediterráneo y Atlántico en la Baja Edad Media "	Broad, well-cited treatment of late medieval piracy/corso between the Mediterranean and Atlantic; published in <i>La Península Ibérica entre el</i>	No match for Pich, Bartolom-, Perpi-, or Rossell- in the accessible PDF text.

Source	What it covers	Result for Pich
	<i>Mediterráneo y el Atlántico</i> , 2006, pp. 255–322.	
Maria Teresa Ferrer Mallol, “ Incidentes piráticos entre Catalanes y Portugueses a fines del siglo XIV y comienzos del XV ”	Specific late-14th/early-15th-century piracy incidents involving Catalans and Portuguese; the article’s abstract notes the multiplication of piracy/corso incidents as maritime transport increased.	No match for Pich or Bartolome- in the accessible text.
Josefina Mutgé Vives, “ La piratería entre la Corona de Aragón y los Reinos de Castilla y Portugal en el siglo XIV ”	Focused on fourteenth-century piracy between the Crown of Aragon, Castile, and Portugal; published in the same 2006 volume, pp. 387–394.	I found no indexed occurrence of Pich in searches tied to this title.
Victòria A. Burguera i Puigserver, “ Jutjar els actes de pirateria a la Corona d’Aragó baixmedieval. El cas de Ponç Descatllar (1440) ”	Useful for legal handling of piracy in the late medieval Crown of Aragon; its bibliography lists many of the major works on the topic.	No match for Pich or Bartolome- on the article page/text.
Maria Dolors López Pérez, “ Piratería y corsarismo en el Mediterráneo occidental medieval... ”	Mallorca-focused control of corsair activity in the late 14th and early 15th centuries; Dialnet lists it in <i>La Mediterrània</i> , 1991, pp. 173–204.	Dialnet has no full text available, so I could not confirm by internal search.

Source	What it covers	Result for Pich
Lawrence Mott, “ Sailing through the Black Death: The Crown of Aragon Fleet Ordinances of 1354 ”	Useful background on Crown of Aragon naval law; Mott describes the 1354 <i>Ordinacions sobre lo fet de la mer</i> as one of the earliest fleet-specific military justice codes.	Not about Pich, but relevant to the legal/maritime environment.

Best conclusion: Bartolomeo Pich appears to be **archivally attested but not well represented in the indexed secondary literature**, at least under that name. Your May 8, 1387 ACA document may be the primary evidence for him, rather than a case already discussed by historians.

For follow-up searching, I would try not only **Pich** but also **Pic, Pichs, Pici/Picci, Pech**, and possibly a Latin genitive form such as **Bartholomei Pich**. I would also search edited ACA regesta or royal-letter calendars for the exact date **8 May 1387** and terms like **pirata, corsarius, latro maris, depredatio, fusta, barca armada**, and **Rossilione/Perpiniano**.

I just found out that the last name of this pirate is actually something like Perich or Paric. Can you repeat this search with that new information?

That new reading is promising because **Perich/Peric/Paric/Parich** opens up a different cluster of Catalan and Occitan-looking variants than **Pich**. I’ll search both the exact forms and likely scribal/printed variants.

Thought for 56s

Yes — the new reading **Perich** produces a much stronger hit, but with an important correction: the clearly attested **Bartomeu Perich** in the secondary literature is described as a **victim/captive of pirates**, not himself as a pirate.

Best match found: Bartomeu Perich of Santa Creu de Rodes

The strongest match is in Eduard Sierra Valentí’s article “**L’altra cara de la Girona medieval**,” published in *Annals de l’Institut d’Estudis Gironins* 47 (2006). Sierra Valentí discusses the *Quesitoria* registers of the Arxiu Diocesà de Girona, which recorded

episcopal licenses to beg alms. He explains that these registers include many cases of captives seeking funds for ransom, especially captives taken by Saracen pirates.

In that article, Sierra Valentí explicitly names:

Bartomeu Perich, de Santa Creu de Rodes

He says Perich was sailing in a Barcelona boat near **Palamós**, close to **Les Medes**, when he was captured by a Saracen galley and taken to **Bugia/Béjaïa** in North Africa. The entry is dated **14 January 1381**, with archival reference **Quesitoria vol. 1, fol. 97v**.

That same case is repeated in Sierra Valentí's later article "**Captius de sarraïns. Llicències per a demanar caritat dels bisbes de Girona (1376–1415)**," *Anuario de Estudios Medievales* 38/1 (2008), pp. 385–428, DOI **10.3989/aem.2008.v38.i1.71**. The article page identifies the title, journal, date, volume, pages, DOI, and author. In the body of the article, Sierra Valentí again notes **Bartomeu Perich de Santa Creu de Rodes**, captive at Bugia and needing **60 florins** for ransom, adding that the recorded narrative shows the role of **Les Medes** as a pirate hiding place.

Why this may matter for your May 8, 1387 document

This is probably **not** the same fact pattern as your document if your May 8, 1387 ACA letter says Bartolomeo/Bartomeu Perich or Paric was **the pirate** active around **Perpignan**. But it is still highly relevant because:

1. **The name Bartomeu Perich is real and documented** in northeastern Catalonia/Roussillon-adjacent maritime contexts.
2. The 1381 case places him near **Palamós/Les Medes**, not Perpignan.
3. He is from **Santa Creu de Rodes**, near Sant Pere de Rodes/Port de la Selva, which is a plausible coastal-world connection.
4. The secondary literature's Perich is a **captive of Saracen pirates**, not a pirate. So your ACA document may either refer to a different Perich/Paric, or the role in your document may need rechecking.

There are also independent historical references to an earlier **Bartomeu Perich** connected with Santa Creu de Rodes: in 1336, the abbot of Sant Pere de Rodes established a Bartomeu Perich as notary of the mountain of Sant Pere, with an obligation to reside at Santa Creu. This appears in local/historical summaries, including *Catalunya Romànica* via Enciclopèdia Catalana, but that 1336 figure is almost certainly a different, earlier person or possibly a family antecedent.

Search result for Paric / Parich / Peric

I did **not** find a convincing academic secondary-literature match for:

- **Bartomeu Paric**
- **Bartolomeo Paric**
- **Bartholomeus Paric**
- **Bartomeu Parich**
- **Bartolomeu Peric**
- **Bartholomeus Perich** as a pirate

The useful hit is specifically **Bartomeu Perich**, and it appears in the context of **captivity and ransom**, not piracy.

Suggested working hypothesis

For your May 8, 1387 document, I would now keep three possibilities open:

Most likely reading cluster:

Bartomeu / Bartholomeus Perich rather than Pich.

Possible document interpretation issue:

The ACA document may involve Perich **in relation to piracy** — perhaps as a captive, shipmaster, victim, ransom case, witness, owner of goods, or intermediary — rather than as the pirate himself.

If he really is the pirate:

Then your document may preserve an otherwise poorly indexed or unpublished archival notice not yet integrated into the secondary literature. In that case, Sierra Valentí's entries are still useful prosopographical comparanda for the name and maritime geography.

The most relevant link is Sierra Valentí's *Annals de l'Institut d'Estudis Gironins* article:

"L'altra cara de la Girona medieval" — it contains the clearest passage naming **Bartomeu Perich** and giving the 1381 archival reference.